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SHORT BIOGRAPHY

I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Urban and Regional Science program at Texas A&M University. I received my Master of Landscape Architecture degree from the University of Idaho (UI) in May 2022, and a BS in Landscape Architecture from UI in May 2020. My primary research areas of interest fall on landscape design, geo-planning, low impact design, site planning, and creative development.

EDUCATION

Texas A&M University, College Station, TX *Aug 2023 – Present*
Ph.D. in Urban & Regional Sciences
Preliminary exam passed, October 2026. Expected graduation: Spring 2027.

University of Idaho, Moscow, ID *Jul 2020 – May 2022*
Master of Landscape Architecture (MLA), May 2022
Cumulative GPA: 4.0/4.0. *Major coursework:* Geodesign in Urban Planning; Regional and Community Design; Graduate Studio.

University of Idaho, Moscow, ID *Jan 2017 – May 2020*
Bachelor of Science in Landscape Architecture, May 2020
Cumulative GPA: 3.6/4.0. *Major coursework:* Built Environment; Site Design; Water Conservation Technologies; Plant Materials and Design; GIS Application in Land Planning; Grading, Drainage, and Stormwater Management.

HONORS AND AWARDS

National

2022 Olmsted Scholar, The Landscape Architecture Foundation (LAF)

State

2024 Texas ASLA Student Design Award
2022 Idaho-Montana ASLA Student Merit Award for Student Achievement

University and College

2026 The Jesus Hinojosa Endowed Urban Planning Scholarship, Texas A&M University
2025 TAMU GIS Day Graduate Poster, 1st Place, Texas A&M University
2024 Graduate Student Small Research Grants, Texas A&M University
2024 Graduate Student Research and Presentation Travel Award, Texas A&M University
2022 GPSA Travel Award, University of Idaho
2021 Art and Architecture Scholarship, University of Idaho
2021 Student Achievement Award, 2020–2021, University of Idaho

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Guo, Z.**, Song, Y., Lu, H., Zhu, R., Zhang, Y., Yoon, H., & Zhang, B. (2026). Quantifying the recreational value of urban parks using smartphone mobility data. *Computational Urban Science, 6*, Article 23. https://doi.org/10.1007/s43762-026-00257-6
2. Tao, Z., Wang, J., Gu, Y., Deal, B., **Guo, Z.**, & Song, Y. (2026). Green infrastructure and post-disaster economic recovery: Empirical evidence from Hurricane Laura. *Land*, *15*(2), Article 224. https://doi.org/10.3390/land15020224
3. Yoon, H., **Guo, Z.**, Song, Y., Lu, H., & Zhang, Y. (2025). Highway as barriers to park visitation: A fixed effects analysis using mobility data. *Urban Science, 9*(12), 512. https://doi.org/10.3390/urbansci9120512

4. Zhang, Y., **Guo, Z.**, Song, Y., & Lu, H. (2025). The impact of crime on urban park visitation patterns: A longitudinal analysis in Austin, Texas. *Urban Forestry & Urban Greening*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ufug.2025.129218
5. Wang, W., Song, Y., Kong, J., **Guo, Z.**, Zhang, Y., Zhu, Z., & Hu, S. (2025). Exploring the spatial relationship between crime and urban places in Austin: A geographically weighted regression approach. *Urban Science, 9*(9), 359. https://doi.org/10.3390/urbansci9090359
6. Liu, P., **Guo, Z.**, Song, Y., & Fernandez, J. (2025). Vulnerable groups in severe heat: A study assessing the impacts of climate and pocket park visitations pre-post the pandemic. *Urban Climate, 61*, 102444. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.uclim.2025.102444
7. Zhao, R., Song, Y., Guo, S., **Guo, Z.**, & Shen, X. (2025). Unraveling the relationships between urban park characteristics and visit durations: A longitudinal smartphone behavior survey in Austin. *Urban Forestry & Urban Greening, 105*, 128706. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ufug.2025.128706
8. Song, Y., **Guo, Z.**, Yang, R., & Wang, N. (2024). Utilizing mobility data to investigate seasonal hourly visiting behavior for downtown parks in Dallas. *Urban Science, 8*(2), 59. https://doi.org/10.3390/urbansci8020059
9. Guo, P., Ding, C., **Guo, Z.**, Liu, T., & Lyu, T. (2022). Coupling CFD simulation and field experiments in summer to prove Feng Shui optimizes courtyard wind environments: A case study of Prince Kung's Mansion in Beijing. *Buildings, 12*(5), 629. https://doi.org/10.3390/buildings12050629

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

1. **Guo, Z.**, Jeong, J., Yoon, H., Song, Y., & Zhang, B. (2026). *Does tree design matter for park visitation? Evidence from mobility data and explainable machine learning* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP), Pittsburgh, PA, United States.
2. Jeong, J., Yoon, H., & **Guo, Z.** (2026). *How tree structure, composition, and configuration influence summer land surface temperature in neighborhood parks* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP), Pittsburgh, PA, United States.
3. **Guo, Z.**, Song, Y., Zhang, Y., Yoon, H., & Hao, Y. (2025). *Using smartphone mobility data to measure recreational value of urban parks: A case study in Austin, Texas* [Poster presentation]. Annual Conference of the American Geophysical Union (AGU), New Orleans, LA, United States.
4. Yoon, H., **Guo, Z.**, Song, Y., Lu, H., & Zhang, Y. (2025). *Urban segregation and park visitation: A longitudinal and place-based study in Austin, Texas* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP), Minneapolis, MN, United States.
5. Zhang, Y., Song, Y., **Guo, Z.**, & Lu, H. (2025). *The impact of crime on urban park visitation patterns: A longitudinal analysis in Austin, Texas* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP), Minneapolis, MN, United States.
6. **Guo, Z.**, Song, Y., Zhang, Y., & Lu, H. (2025). *Quantifying the economic benefits of urban parks using the travel cost method: A data-driven study in Austin, TX* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Council of Educators in Landscape Architecture (CELA), Portland, OR, United States.
7. Rezaeimalek, S., Fernandez, J., Song, Y., & **Guo, Z.** (2025). *Determining the combined influence of park characteristics and socio-economic factors on community park visitation patterns in Atlanta, GA* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Council of Educators in Landscape Architecture (CELA), Portland, OR, United States.
8. **Guo, Z.**, & Song, Y. (2024). *Assessing the economic value of urban parks with mobility data in Austin, TX* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP), Seattle, WA, United States.
9. Zhao, R., Song, Y., Guo, S., & **Guo, Z.** (2024). *Park features influencing visit durations: A longitudinal survey in Austin* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP), Seattle, WA, United States.
10. **Guo, Z.**, Song, Y., & Hao, Y. (2024). *Utilizing big data to validate the influence of elevated temperatures on the visiting behavior of varied demographic categories in Dallas* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Council of Educators in Landscape Architecture (CELA), St. Louis, MO, United States.

11. **Guo, Z.**, Cronan, D., & Elkin, D. (2022). *Stormwater learning typologies: Best management practices for Portland Public Schools* [Paper presentation]. Annual Conference of the Council of Educators in Landscape Architecture (CELA), New Mexico, United States.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Co-Instructor, LAND 212 Landscape Design II *Spring 2026*

Texas A&M University · 39 BLA students

Undergraduate landscape architecture design studio organized around two applied design projects. The first project focused on campus landscape design, while the second involved a community-based landscape design project for Harrison County. Responsibilities included studio instruction, individual and group critiques, guidance on design development and graphic communication, and feedback on project presentations. Detailed project descriptions and student work are included in the teaching portfolio.

Guest Lecturer, URPN 325 Introduction to GIS in Urban Planning *Spring 2026*

Texas A&M University · 17 students

Delivered a guest lecture on practical applications of GIS in landscape architecture and design. The lecture introduced several GIS-based tools and workflows relevant to site analysis, spatial assessment, and landscape planning, and presented landscape design case studies demonstrating how GIS can support design analysis and decision-making.

Co-Instructor, LAND 601 Landscape Architectural Design Foundations *Fall 2025*

Texas A&M University · 6 MLA students

This introductory graduate design studio introduces foundational principles of landscape architecture through an emphasis on form, space, and function. Students explore how spatial relationships are shaped by landform, vegetation, circulation, and human use, developing three-dimensional design thinking through a sequence of three projects. Project 1 focuses on the design of a central campus plaza, emphasizing spatial definition, plant-based form-making, and pedestrian experience. Project 2 advances these concepts through the design of Eastgate Park, prioritizing durable amenities, restrained formal expression, and legible circulation. Project 3 challenges students to apply form-based thinking to real-world contexts in Alto, TX or Rio Grande City, TX, addressing ecological processes, social connection, and community identity. Across all projects, students employ hand drawing, physical modeling, and schematic digital representation to communicate design intent, with a strong emphasis on visual thinking, spatial sectioning, and poster-based presentation.

Co-Instructor, LAND 212 Landscape Design II *Spring 2025*

Texas A&M University · 43 BLA students

This second studio in the landscape design sequence builds on prior coursework to shift students' focus from the form of design to the meaning of form. Emphasizing the relationship between human behavior and design decisions, students explore how physical settings influence social interaction, psychological well-being, and active living. Through three individual and team-based design projects, students apply site-sensitive strategies combining natural systems (landform, vegetation, climate) and human-made systems (paths, structures, utilities). The course develops students' ability to observe human behavior, perform site analysis, and synthesize data into environmentally and culturally responsive design solutions. Analog and digital tools are used to communicate ideas, with an emphasis on visual thinking, sketching, and presentation graphics.

Teaching Assistant, LAND 601 Landscape Architecture Design Fundamentals *Fall 2024*

Texas A&M University · 5 MLA students

This first design studio course for career-change students introduces the fundamentals of landscape architecture, focusing on form-making skills and the application of landscape materials such as landform, water, vegetation, and circulation. Through multiple short design projects, students explore basic design theories and principles with an emphasis on context-sensitive and evidence-based approaches. The course develops skills in translating abstract concepts into 3-dimensional spatial forms, using both analog and digital tools to communicate ideas clearly and effectively.

Co-Instructor, LAND 212 Landscape Design II *Spring 2024*

Texas A&M University · 38 BLA students

This studio course is the second introductory course in landscape design, following LAND 211. The focus shifts from the form of design to the meaning of form. Students will engage in three main projects: Campus Plaza design, City of Bryan Downtown Pocket Park design, and Southeast Community Park design. Students will develop the ability to apply basic site design principles, combining human factors with natural systems to create usable three-dimensional spaces that are environmentally, socially, and culturally equitable. The course also introduces tools and methods for the systematic design process, including mapping, trace measures, and observation to understand and analyze human behaviors.

Teaching Assistant, URPN 220 Digital Communication I *Fall 2023*

Texas A&M University · 45 students

Explores the intersection of urban planning and digital technologies. The course covers various digital tools and communication strategies for effective information dissemination and public engagement in urban planning. Students learn to utilize software for design visualization, data analysis, and create digital content that supports urban planning projects.

Teaching Assistant, LAND 601 Landscape Architecture Design Theory and Application *Fall 2023*

Texas A&M University · 12 MLA students

Landscape Architecture Design Theory and Application is a course focused on the interplay between conceptual design theories and their practical application in landscape architecture. Students examine historical and contemporary design principles, applying them to real-world projects. Emphasizing sustainability, cultural relevance, and technological trends, the course fosters critical thinking and innovative design solutions for environmental challenges.

Co-Instructor, LARC 380 Water Conservation Technologies *Spring 2022*

University of Idaho · 8 students

Applied a set of tutorials that delivered all lecture material, images, and a series of in-class exercises to extend the understanding of the material. Each student is expected to view and learn the text and images in the tutorials before coming to the weekly class meetings. Guided the students to review the tutorials before attempting the assignments. The class meetings will be devoted largely to developing design exercises.

Co-Instructor, LARC 210 Landscape Architecture Representation and Media *Spring 2021*

University of Idaho · 16 students

Facilitated a discussion section or tutorial; hold weekly office hours; grade homework, programming assignments, exams, or projects; keep records; distribute and copy reading materials; prepare answer keys or supplementary notes; and act as the course webmaster.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Project Lead, Landscape Design Feasibility Tool *Summer 2026*

Texas A&M AgriLife · Project manager: Jamie Rae R. Walker

Developed a feasibility and cost-estimation toolkit for Texas communities and resource-limited planning agencies. Created cost tables, budgeting worksheets, and lifecycle planning tools for landscape elements including trails, parking, signage, vegetation, lighting, and other site improvements.

Project Lead, Harrison County Trail Design Project *Summer 2026*

Texas A&M AgriLife · Harrison County, TX · Project managers: Jamie Rae R. Walker and Yang Song

Worked with clients to develop a multi-use trail system using site and LiDAR data. Designed three trail types for different recreational functions, prepared CAD plans and parking layouts, and developed material quantities and construction cost estimates.

Project Lead, Alto Landscape Design Project *Summer 2026*

Texas A&M AgriLife · Alto, TX · Project managers: Jamie Rae R. Walker and Yang Song

Collaborated with clients and project managers to develop site and landscape design proposals for the City of Alto. Prepared CAD site plans, parking and circulation designs, construction cost estimates, and supporting design materials for project planning and funding applications.

Assistant Advisor, Charlotte Sharp Children's Center Project *Summer 2025*

College Station, TX

Collaborated with faculty and university partners to design a nature-based children's garden for the Charlotte Sharp Children's Center. Responsibilities included conducting site inventory and analysis, preparing conceptual and schematic designs, producing rendered master plans, and presenting design solutions to stakeholders. The project emphasized universal accessibility, play safety standards (ASTM F1487, CPSC), ecological sustainability, and developmental enrichment for early childhood education.

Assistant Advisor, Houston Methodist Hospital — Neal Cancer Center *Summer 2025*

Houston, TX

Participated in the design of a rooftop therapeutic garden supporting patient healing and staff wellness. Tasks included site documentation, concept development, schematic and final design plans, and 3D visualizations. The project focused on biophilic design, sensory engagement, passive use, and compliance with best practices in sustainable healthcare design. Presented final deliverables to hospital stakeholders as part of the campus-wide wellness initiative.

Assistant Advisor, Montgomery County Precinct 4 Parks Master Plan *Summer 2025*

Montgomery County, TX

Supported the development of a parks master plan covering over 160 acres across nine parks in Montgomery County, TX. Tasks included park inventory and assessment, demographic research, analysis of recreation standards, and the creation of site-specific conceptual plans. Contributed to the final planning document that included facility programming, schematic designs, and implementation strategies to guide future investments in community recreation infrastructure.

Landscape Architecture Intern, Cobblestone Landscape LLC *2021*

Moscow, ID

Took charge of all facets of the company's landscape design/build operations in Moscow, Idaho, and the surrounding areas. Tasks included, but were not limited to, aiding the design team with site inventory and analysis, conceptual design, drafting, modeling, and cost estimating, as well as gaining hands-on experience assisting one of the build crews in their daily construction activities.

ACADEMIC AND DEPARTMENTAL SERVICE

Lecture Series Coordinator *Fall 2025 – Spring 2026*

Department of Landscape Architecture and Urban Planning, Texas A&M University

Coordinated the LAUP Lecture Series for the 2025–2026 academic year, featuring distinguished speakers in landscape architecture, urban planning, and sustainable design. Oversaw event logistics, communication, and promotion, strengthening departmental engagement and academic exchange.

Assistant Advisor, Partnership for Community Outreach (PCO) *Summer 2025*

Texas A&M University · 4 MLA student interns

As part of the Partnership for Community Outreach (PCO) initiative in Summer 2025, graduate interns collaborated on three community-centered design projects across Texas: the Houston Methodist Hospital Neal Cancer Center Therapeutic Garden (Houston), the Charlotte Sharp Children's Center Garden (College Station), and the Montgomery County Precinct 4 Parks Master Plan. Working with faculty, local agencies, and nonprofits, students developed site-sensitive designs focused on therapeutic landscapes, child-friendly environments, and regional park planning. Responsibilities included site analysis, concept development, stakeholder engagement, and final presentations using both analog and digital tools.

Guest Lecturer, URPN 325 Introduction to GIS in Urban Planning *Spring 2026*

Texas A&M University

Delivered a guest lecture to undergraduate planning students on the application of Geographic Information Systems in landscape architecture. The session introduced how GIS can be used as a decision-support tool for site analysis and early-stage design development. Emphasis was placed on translating spatial data into actionable insights, including evaluating topography, hydrology, land use, and accessibility to inform planning and design strategies. Students were also introduced to efficient workflows for rapid site analysis and concept generation, demonstrating how GIS can support evidence-based and time-sensitive design processes.

PEER REVIEW SERVICE

Abstract Reviewer, Council of Educators in Landscape Architecture (CELA) 2027 Annual Conference *2026*

Peer Reviewer, *Environment and Planning B: Urban Analytics and City Science (SAGE)* *2026*

Peer Reviewer, *Pattern Recognition (Elsevier)* *2026*

Peer Reviewer, *Journal of Asian Architecture and Building Engineering (Taylor & Francis)* *2026*

Peer Reviewer, *Forum Geografi* *2026*